

Association for Digital Progress ADP - CODEX CODE OF ETHICS

1. Purpose of the Code

The Association for Digital Progress ADP - CODEX is committed to conducting all of its activities with the highest standards of ethics, integrity, professionalism, and accountability.

This Code of Ethics establishes the principles and standards that govern the conduct of all individuals acting on behalf of the Association, including members, directors, employees, volunteers, consultants, interns, contractors, project partners, and any other persons representing ADP.

The purpose of this Code is to:

- promote a culture of honesty, integrity, and professionalism;
- strengthen public confidence in the Association;
- ensure responsible and transparent decision-making;
- encourage ethical leadership and good governance;
- safeguard the rights and dignity of every individual;
- support responsible innovation and the ethical use of digital technologies;
- ensure compliance with applicable laws, regulations, donor requirements, and internationally recognized ethical standards.

This Code serves not only as a set of rules but also as a practical guide for ethical decision-making. Every person acting on behalf of ADP is expected to understand, respect, and apply these principles in their daily activities.

Ethical behavior is considered a fundamental responsibility and an essential condition for maintaining the credibility, sustainability, and long-term success of the Association.

2. Mission and Ethical Commitment

The Association for Digital Progress ADP - CODEX exists to contribute to the digital transformation of society through education, innovation, research, technological development, and international cooperation.

ADP believes that digital technologies should serve humanity, promote equal opportunities, improve quality of life, strengthen democratic values, and contribute to sustainable development.

The Association is committed to conducting all of its activities in accordance with the following ethical commitments:

- acting honestly, fairly, and responsibly in every activity;
- respecting human dignity, equality, and fundamental rights;
- promoting inclusion and equal access to digital opportunities;
- encouraging innovation while considering ethical and societal impacts;
- protecting privacy, confidentiality, and personal data;
- ensuring transparency and accountability in governance and financial management;
- preventing corruption, fraud, discrimination, harassment, and abuse of authority;
- fostering cooperation based on mutual respect and trust;
- contributing to sustainable environmental, economic, and social development.

ADP recognizes that ethical responsibility extends beyond legal compliance. Whenever ethical standards exceed legal obligations, the Association strives to follow the higher standard in order to protect the public interest and maintain public confidence.

Every member of the Association shares responsibility for creating an ethical organizational culture where integrity, respect, professionalism, and accountability are demonstrated through everyday actions.

The Association encourages open dialogue regarding ethical questions and supports individuals who raise concerns in good faith regarding potential ethical violations.

3. Core Values

The activities, decisions, and strategic direction of the Association for Digital Progress ADP - CODEX are guided by a set of core values that define its organizational culture and ethical identity.

3.1 Integrity

We act honestly, ethically, and consistently. We keep our promises, avoid deceptive practices, and always place ethical considerations above personal interests.

3.2 Professionalism

We strive for excellence in all our work by maintaining high professional standards, continuously improving our knowledge and skills, and delivering quality results.

3.3 Transparency

We conduct our activities openly and responsibly. Decisions, financial resources, and organizational processes are managed in a transparent manner that promotes public trust.

3.4 Accountability

We accept responsibility for our decisions, actions, and their consequences. We are accountable to our members, beneficiaries, donors, partners, public institutions, and society.

3.5 Respect

We respect the dignity, diversity, opinions, cultures, beliefs, and rights of every individual. We promote an inclusive environment free from discrimination, harassment, and intolerance.

3.6 Innovation

We encourage creativity, research, digital innovation, and lifelong learning while ensuring that technological advancement remains aligned with ethical principles and societal well-being.

3.7 Collaboration

We believe that meaningful progress is achieved through cooperation, knowledge sharing, partnership, and mutual respect among individuals and organizations.

3.8 Independence

We maintain our institutional independence and make decisions free from improper political, financial, commercial, or personal influence.

3.9 Sustainability

We support solutions that contribute to long-term environmental protection, social inclusion, responsible resource management, and sustainable digital development.

3.10 Public Benefit

All activities undertaken by ADP are intended to serve the public interest and contribute positively to communities, particularly through education, digital literacy, innovation, scientific development, and social inclusion.

These values form the ethical foundation of the Association and guide every policy, project, partnership, and decision undertaken by ADP.

4. Scope of Application

This Code of Ethics applies to all individuals acting on behalf of the Association for Digital Progress ADP - CODEX, regardless of their role, position, or contractual relationship with the Association.

The provisions of this Code are binding upon:

- Members of the General Assembly;
- Members of the Board of Directors;
- Members of supervisory, advisory, and working committees;
- Employees and contracted personnel;
- Volunteers and interns;

- Consultants and external experts;
- Project staff;
- Partner organizations when required by contractual agreements;
- Any individual representing ADP in meetings, conferences, projects, or public activities.

Every person covered by this Code is expected to familiarize themselves with its principles and to conduct themselves accordingly.

Managers and project leaders have an additional responsibility to promote ethical behavior, provide guidance, and foster a culture of integrity within the Association.

Failure to comply with this Code may result in appropriate disciplinary or contractual measures in accordance with applicable legislation, internal regulations, and contractual obligations.

5. Integrity and Professional Conduct

Integrity forms the foundation of every activity carried out by ADP.

All representatives of the Association shall perform their duties honestly, responsibly, objectively, and in good faith.

Individuals acting on behalf of ADP shall:

- perform their responsibilities competently and diligently;
- avoid misleading statements or deceptive practices;
- provide accurate and truthful information;
- respect professional standards within their respective fields;
- avoid abuse of authority, position, or organizational resources;
- treat colleagues, beneficiaries, and partners fairly and respectfully;
- protect the reputation and credibility of the Association.

Professional decisions shall always be based on objective criteria, evidence, expertise, and the public interest rather than personal preferences or external pressures.

Members shall avoid any conduct that could reasonably damage the integrity, independence, or reputation of ADP.

6. Respect for Human Rights and Diversity

ADP is committed to promoting and protecting internationally recognized human rights in all its activities.

The Association embraces diversity as a source of innovation, creativity, and organizational strength.

Discrimination based on race, ethnicity, nationality, language, religion, political opinion, disability, age, gender, sexual orientation, marital status, socioeconomic background, or any other protected characteristic shall not be tolerated.

ADP is committed to:

- providing equal opportunities;
- respecting cultural diversity;
- promoting accessibility and digital inclusion;
- ensuring equal participation in projects and activities;
- preventing harassment, intimidation, bullying, and hate speech;
- fostering a respectful and inclusive working environment.

All individuals shall be treated with dignity, fairness, and respect regardless of their personal characteristics or beliefs.

7. Transparency and Accountability

Transparency is essential for maintaining public trust and organizational credibility.

ADP is committed to conducting its governance, financial management, procurement, project implementation, and decision-making processes in an open and accountable manner.

The Association shall:

- maintain accurate organizational records;
- provide reliable financial reporting;
- communicate honestly with members, donors, beneficiaries, and the public;
- disclose relevant information whenever appropriate;
- manage public and donor funds responsibly;
- comply with applicable reporting obligations.

Accountability requires every individual to accept responsibility for their decisions, actions, and professional conduct.

Mistakes shall be acknowledged openly and corrected promptly whenever possible.

The Association encourages continuous evaluation, learning, and improvement in order to strengthen institutional performance.

8. Conflict of Interest

Individuals acting on behalf of ADP shall always place the interests of the Association above personal, financial, political, or family interests.

A conflict of interest exists whenever personal interests could influence—or appear to influence—professional judgment or organizational decisions.

Potential conflicts may arise through:

- financial interests;
- family relationships;
- outside employment;
- consulting activities;
- political positions;
- gifts or benefits;
- procurement decisions;
- project evaluations;
- recruitment processes.

Whenever a conflict of interest exists or may reasonably be perceived, the individual shall:

- disclose the conflict immediately;
- refrain from participating in the relevant decision-making process;
- comply with any mitigation measures established by the Association.

The Board of Directors shall establish appropriate procedures for identifying, documenting, and managing conflicts of interest.

Failure to disclose a significant conflict of interest may constitute a serious ethical violation.

9. Confidentiality and Data Protection

ADP recognizes that trust depends upon the responsible handling of confidential information and personal data.

All individuals acting on behalf of the Association shall protect confidential information obtained through their work and shall not disclose such information without proper authorization unless required by law.

Confidential information may include:

- personal information;
- project documentation;

- research data;
- financial information;
- contractual documents;
- donor information;
- internal strategies;
- technical documentation;
- intellectual property.

The Association is committed to complying with applicable data protection legislation, including internationally recognized privacy principles and, where applicable, the General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR).

Personal data shall be:

- collected lawfully;
- processed fairly;
- stored securely;
- accessed only by authorized individuals;
- retained only as long as necessary;
- protected against unauthorized access, disclosure, alteration, or destruction.

Everyone working with ADP shares responsibility for maintaining information security and protecting the privacy rights of individuals.

10. Responsible Use of Digital Technologies and Artificial Intelligence

As an organization dedicated to digital development, ADP recognizes its special responsibility to promote the ethical design, development, deployment, and use of digital technologies and artificial intelligence.

The Association supports innovation that benefits society while minimizing potential risks to individuals, communities, and democratic institutions.

ADP is committed to ensuring that digital technologies are:

- human-centered;
- transparent where appropriate;
- secure and reliable;
- fair and non-discriminatory;

- accessible and inclusive;
- environmentally responsible;
- respectful of privacy and fundamental rights.

Artificial intelligence systems developed, promoted, or used by the Association should be designed to support human decision-making rather than replace human responsibility.

Whenever AI is used in research, education, public services, or organizational processes, appropriate measures should be taken to:

- reduce algorithmic bias;
- protect personal data;
- ensure transparency regarding AI-assisted decisions where appropriate;
- maintain meaningful human oversight;
- assess potential ethical risks before deployment.

The Association opposes the misuse of digital technologies for surveillance without legal basis, manipulation, discrimination, misinformation, cybercrime, or violations of human rights.

ADP encourages responsible digital innovation that contributes to sustainable development, social inclusion, education, scientific advancement, and the public good.

11. Research Ethics and Innovation

The Association for Digital Progress ADP - CODEX promotes scientific research, technological innovation, and knowledge creation as essential drivers of sustainable development. All research and innovation activities conducted or supported by the Association shall adhere to the highest ethical and professional standards.

ADP is committed to ensuring that research is carried out honestly, responsibly, transparently, and with respect for human dignity, fundamental rights, and the public interest.

Researchers, experts, and project teams shall:

- conduct research objectively and independently;
- report findings accurately without fabrication, falsification, or selective reporting;
- acknowledge the work and intellectual contributions of others;
- respect copyright, intellectual property rights, and academic integrity;
- avoid plagiarism in all forms;
- obtain all necessary ethical approvals before conducting research involving human participants, personal data, or sensitive information;
- ensure that participation in research is voluntary whenever applicable;
- minimize potential risks to participants and society.

Innovation should always contribute positively to society. New technologies should be developed and implemented with careful consideration of their ethical, legal, environmental, and social implications.

The Association encourages interdisciplinary collaboration, open scientific dialogue, responsible data sharing where appropriate, and continuous improvement in research quality.

Research funded by public institutions or international donors shall comply with all applicable ethical requirements established by funding organizations and relevant legislation.

12. Environmental and Social Responsibility

ADP recognizes that digital transformation and technological development must contribute to environmental sustainability and social well-being.

The Association is committed to integrating environmental, social, and governance (ESG) principles into its activities, projects, and organizational practices.

ADP shall strive to:

- minimize the environmental impact of its operations;
- promote responsible use of natural resources;
- encourage energy-efficient digital solutions;
- reduce unnecessary paper consumption through digitalization;
- promote responsible electronic waste management;
- support environmentally sustainable innovation.

Beyond environmental responsibility, the Association is equally committed to strengthening social cohesion and equal opportunities.

ADP promotes initiatives that:

- improve digital inclusion;
- reduce inequalities in access to technology;
- support lifelong learning;
- empower young people, women, persons with disabilities, and vulnerable groups;
- strengthen local communities through digital innovation;
- contribute to sustainable economic development.

The Association believes that technological progress should improve the quality of life for present and future generations while protecting both society and the environment.

13. Relations with Public Institutions, Partners, and Donors

ADP values long-term partnerships built upon mutual trust, transparency, professionalism, and shared ethical principles.

The Association cooperates with:

- public institutions;
- local and international organizations;
- educational institutions;
- research centers;
- civil society organizations;
- private sector partners;
- donor agencies;
- international organizations.

All relationships shall be conducted fairly, respectfully, and in accordance with applicable laws, contractual obligations, and ethical standards.

ADP shall:

- honor all contractual commitments;
- provide accurate and timely information;
- ensure responsible management of project resources;
- avoid favoritism and conflicts of interest;
- respect the independence of partner organizations;
- maintain confidentiality where required.

The Association shall not knowingly cooperate with organizations or individuals engaged in corruption, fraud, discrimination, serious human rights violations, or other unethical practices.

Acceptance of external funding shall never compromise the independence, mission, or ethical principles of the Association.

Donors shall not influence research findings, educational content, policy positions, or organizational decisions in ways that undermine the integrity of ADP.

14. Financial Integrity

The responsible management of financial resources is a fundamental ethical obligation of the Association.

All financial activities shall be conducted with honesty, transparency, accountability, and full compliance with applicable legislation, donor requirements, and accepted accounting standards.

ADP shall ensure that:

- financial records are complete, accurate, and up to date;
- all expenditures are properly documented;
- organizational assets are used solely for legitimate organizational purposes;
- procurement processes are fair, competitive, and transparent;
- project funds are used exclusively for approved project activities;
- financial reports accurately reflect the use of resources.

Fraud, embezzlement, bribery, corruption, falsification of financial records, misuse of organizational assets, and any form of financial misconduct are strictly prohibited.

Individuals responsible for financial management shall exercise due diligence and maintain appropriate internal controls to safeguard the Association's assets.

Any suspected financial irregularity shall be reported immediately through the appropriate reporting mechanisms and investigated impartially.

The Association supports independent financial audits and welcomes external oversight as an important element of good governance and public accountability.

15. Communication and Public Representation

Every individual representing ADP contributes to the reputation and public image of the Association.

All public communications shall be truthful, accurate, respectful, and consistent with the mission and values of the Association.

Individuals acting on behalf of ADP shall:

- communicate honestly and professionally;
- avoid misleading or exaggerated statements;
- distinguish personal opinions from official organizational positions;
- respect confidentiality obligations;
- use respectful language in all forms of communication;
- promote constructive dialogue and mutual understanding.

Public statements made in the name of the Association should be authorized in accordance with internal procedures.

The use of social media by members, employees, and volunteers should reflect professionalism and should not damage the reputation of the Association or undermine public confidence in its work.

The Association encourages responsible digital communication that promotes factual information, respectful discussion, digital literacy, and responsible civic engagement.

ADP does not tolerate the dissemination of false information, hate speech, discriminatory content, or communication that incites violence, hostility, or unlawful behavior.

16. Volunteer and Employee Responsibilities

Every employee, volunteer, consultant, intern, contractor, Board member, and representative of ADP shares responsibility for maintaining the ethical standards established by this Code.

Individuals acting on behalf of the Association shall:

- read, understand, and comply with this Code of Ethics;
- perform their duties with honesty, diligence, and professionalism;
- respect applicable laws, organizational policies, and contractual obligations;
- protect the interests and reputation of the Association;
- use organizational resources responsibly and efficiently;
- maintain confidentiality of sensitive information;
- avoid discrimination, harassment, intimidation, and abusive behavior;
- cooperate respectfully with colleagues, beneficiaries, partners, and public authorities;
- report suspected ethical violations in good faith;
- participate in ethics-related training when required.

Employees and volunteers are encouraged to seek advice whenever they are uncertain about the ethical implications of a particular decision or action.

Managers and supervisors have additional responsibilities to:

- lead by personal example;
- foster an ethical organizational culture;
- provide guidance on ethical issues;
- ensure that ethical concerns are taken seriously;
- support individuals who report concerns in good faith;
- prevent retaliation against whistleblowers.

Ethical leadership is considered an essential responsibility of every person holding a position of authority within the Association.

17. Reporting Ethical Concerns (Whistleblowing)

ADP encourages an organizational culture in which ethical concerns may be raised openly, responsibly, and without fear of retaliation.

Every individual acting on behalf of the Association has both the right and the responsibility to report suspected violations of this Code, applicable laws, organizational policies, donor requirements, or other serious misconduct.

Examples of reportable concerns include, but are not limited to:

- fraud or corruption;
- bribery;
- conflicts of interest;
- financial misconduct;
- discrimination or harassment;
- abuse of authority;
- misuse of organizational assets;
- violations of privacy or data protection;
- research misconduct;
- serious violations of this Code of Ethics.

Reports may be submitted through confidential internal reporting mechanisms established by the Association.

Individuals making reports in good faith shall be protected against retaliation, intimidation, discrimination, dismissal, or any other adverse treatment resulting solely from their report.

Knowingly submitting false or malicious allegations constitutes a violation of this Code and may result in disciplinary measures.

All reported concerns shall be reviewed promptly, fairly, impartially, and confidentially.

Investigations shall respect the rights of all parties involved and follow principles of due process, confidentiality, proportionality, and fairness.

18. Enforcement and Disciplinary Measures

Compliance with this Code of Ethics is a condition of participation in the activities and governance of the Association.

The Board of Directors shall oversee the implementation of this Code and may establish an Ethics Committee or designate responsible persons to support its effective application.

When a potential ethical violation is identified, the Association shall:

1. receive and document the concern;
2. conduct a preliminary assessment;
3. initiate an impartial investigation where appropriate;
4. provide the concerned individual with an opportunity to respond;
5. determine appropriate corrective or disciplinary measures;
6. document the final decision.

Disciplinary measures shall be proportionate to the nature and seriousness of the violation.

Possible measures may include:

- verbal or written warning;
- mandatory ethics training;
- temporary suspension from specific responsibilities;
- removal from project activities;
- termination of volunteer or employment relationships where applicable;
- removal from elected or appointed positions in accordance with the Association's Statute;
- referral to competent public authorities where required by law.

The Association favors corrective and educational approaches whenever appropriate but will take firm action in cases involving intentional misconduct, corruption, fraud, abuse, or repeated ethical violations.

19. Review and Amendment of the Code

Ethical standards evolve alongside technological, legal, and societal developments.

For this reason, ADP is committed to regularly reviewing and improving this Code of Ethics to ensure that it remains relevant, effective, and consistent with international best practices.

This Code shall normally be reviewed at least once every three years, or earlier whenever significant legal, organizational, technological, or operational changes occur.

Suggestions for amendments may be submitted by:

- members of the Association;
- the Board of Directors;
- committees and working groups;
- employees and volunteers;
- external experts when appropriate.

All proposed amendments shall be evaluated transparently and adopted in accordance with the procedures established by the Statute of the Association.

The most recent approved version of the Code shall be made available to all members and published on the Association's official website whenever appropriate.

20. Final Provisions

This Code of Ethics was adopted by the Association for Digital Progress ADP - CODEX as a fundamental framework for ethical governance, responsible leadership, and professional conduct.

The Code shall enter into force on the date of its approval by the competent governing body of the Association.

All members, employees, volunteers, consultants, contractors, project staff, and representatives of ADP are expected to comply with its principles and actively promote its implementation.

Nothing in this Code replaces applicable laws or contractual obligations. Where legal requirements establish higher standards than those contained in this Code, the higher standard shall prevail.

Where this Code establishes standards exceeding minimum legal requirements, individuals acting on behalf of ADP are expected to follow the higher ethical standard.

The Board of Directors shall be responsible for promoting awareness of this Code, supporting its implementation, and encouraging continuous ethical improvement throughout the Association.

By embracing these principles, the Association reaffirms its commitment to integrity, innovation, transparency, accountability, respect for human dignity, responsible digital transformation, and sustainable development.

ADP believes that ethical conduct is not merely a legal obligation but a shared commitment that strengthens public trust, supports responsible innovation, and contributes to a more inclusive, equitable, and digitally empowered society.

Appendix A – Acknowledgement of the Code of Ethics (*Optional but Recommended*)

Acknowledgement Statement

I acknowledge that I have received, read, and understood the Association for Digital Progress ADP - CODEX Code of Ethics.

I understand that compliance with this Code is a condition of my participation in the activities of the Association, and I agree to uphold its principles in all actions undertaken on behalf of ADP.

I also understand my responsibility to seek guidance when ethical questions arise and to report, in good faith, any suspected violations of this Code.

Name

Position

Signature

Date

